

Case Study: Cyberbullying

Cyberbullying is a type of cybercrime where a person is repeatedly harassed, mocked, or threatened through digital platforms such as social media, messaging apps, or online groups. Unlike offline bullying, it can continue at any time and spread quickly to a large audience, making it more harmful and difficult to escape.

A realistic example involves Riya, a first-year college student who had recently moved away from home. She posted photos and shared her college experiences on social media to stay connected with friends. After a classroom disagreement, a few students started leaving negative comments on her posts. Soon, fake screenshots and edited images were shared in college WhatsApp groups, making fun of her appearance and personality. Anonymous accounts began sending her insulting messages daily. Even students who did not know her personally started reacting and sharing the content, which increased her embarrassment.

Young students and active social media users are common targets because their online presence makes them easily visible. Over time, Riya became anxious about checking her phone, avoided attending classes, and lost confidence in interacting with others.

Cyberbullying can seriously affect mental health, leading to stress, isolation, and reduced academic performance. This case shows how careless online behavior can cause real emotional harm and highlights the need for empathy, responsible digital conduct, and timely reporting of online harassment.